

SOP-FIRE-610: Hot Work Permit Procedure

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Section 1. Purpose and Scope

Governs any work producing open flame, sparks, or sufficient heat to ignite flammable material — welding, cutting, grinding, brazing, and soldering — outside a designated permanent hot work area.

Section 2. Permit Requirement

Clause 2.1 — A Hot Work Permit is required before starting any hot work outside a designated welding shop, valid for one shift only and specific to one location.

Clause 2.2 — A fire watch is mandatory for the duration of the work plus 30 minutes after work stops, and shall have no other assigned duties during that period.

Section 3. Area Preparation

Clause 3.1 — Combustible material within 35 feet of the work shall be removed or covered with a fire-resistant blanket before the permit is signed.

Clause 3.3 — Where hot work is performed on a vessel, pipe, or tank that has contained flammable material, atmospheric testing per SOP-CSE-200 Section 2 is required before the permit is issued, regardless of whether confined space entry is also involved.

Section 4. Fire Watch Equipment

Clause 4.1 — The fire watch shall have a charged fire extinguisher rated for the specific combustible hazard present, verified inspected within the current month per SOP-FIRE-640.

Section 5. Permit Closure

Clause 5.2 — The permit issuer or fire watch shall inspect the area 30 minutes after work stops and again at the end of shift before signing the permit as closed.

Section 6. Records

Clause 6.1 — Closed hot work permits are filed to the Fire Protection File and retained for 3 years.